all over Mizoram.

Kiran's first priority was to put to optimal use the resources at her command, in the form of the police force. When she took over, things used to move at a very personal level rather than at a professional or institutional level. Consequently, she tried to reform her force; at least those personnel working at the headquarters. An almost abject laxity marked the pattern of working, especially the keeping of records. Consequently, every case had to be taken up from scratch each time. Kiran took several steps to rectify this situation.

Kiran's approach has always been to take the initiative to prevent a crime rather than merely catching and punishing the criminal. In Mizoram also, she resorted to her time-tested method of seeking community participation for preventive policing. With regular updating of the scanty record system, her office was able to attain a position where it could keep track of criminals through their antecedents and ascertain whether a particular culprit was still traceable and whether he was still active in a life of crime or had given it up. A list of people with known criminal records was drawn up, which was circulated amongst the community at the village level and also amongst the village defence parties (VDPs) and the YMCA. Such open identification helped deter a lot of criminals from carrying on their activities. Another benefit gained was in the form of information given by the criminal caught, which helped in the arrest of those who persisted with their old ways.

The language problem was resolved as her staff officer, Lalhuliana, was fluent in both English and Mizo. Through him she could reach out to her officers and other staff at different levels of understanding, commitment and motivation. The briefings were held so often and so regularly that the staff officer gradually did not even have to be explained in English but would rattle off the needful in Mizo straightaway to the groups. If it was to be a lecture on 'management' then all he required to be cued in was to be merely told the subject and off he would go.

'It is very important that the staff be given direct access to their seniors to promote motivation, involvement and innovative experimentation in the ranks,' believes Kiran. Her constables were the happiest with her because of this belief. As a matter of fact, wherever she has served, her constables have always sworn by her and are very forthcoming in telling one and all that they felt secure under her leadership. Obviously, there was a marked change in their attitude and performance. And as there were discernible improvements in the scruffy looking Goa traffic police force, so also was the case in Aizawl.

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The beat system that had been implemented in Delhi was put into effect in Mizoram too. The hitherto lacklustre, lethargic Mizo cop suddenly found he could wield authority in his beat. Also, he realized that along with this authority came responsibility too and the lure of the one motivated him to aspire for the other. Thus, the Mizo cops began policing their beats under their own initiatives, taking their own decisions. The all-too-new briefings and debriefings and the regular roll calls each morning and evening made them alert to the responsibilities related to the incidents and inhabitants of their respective areas. With the ready reckoner of criminals that had been prepared and the new-found responsibility they felt towards their beats, policing did indeed become more effective.

What greatly assisted in this positive development was the fact that probably because of their nature, but certainly through circumstances, the Mizos are a very organized community. Almost everyone belonged to one organization or the other. The existence of these organizations helped the force a lot as their support was very forthcoming. For instance, there were the village councils, village defence parties, youth wings and the women's organization, the MHIP [Mizoram Women's